

Folk Songs





About the Course

Students sing folk songs connected to the time period (1800-1900).

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Intro, Music: Level 1, Music: Level 2, Music: Level 3, Music: Level 4, Music: Level 5

Folk Songs

The purpose of learning folk songs is twofold: to increase students' enjoyment of music and to situate folk music in its historical context in an effort to give students a richer understanding of the times and places that birthed the songs. A musical score is sometimes included for songs, but does not always exactly match the audio used, since folk songs are primarily oral songs and often take many different forms. Studying folk music helps students grow deep roots in our shared heritage and gives insight into historical events from the perspective of the people who were there.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Folk Songs 1 time/week 10 min	Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Intro				
Sol-fa: Musical Games	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Music Appreciation
Music: Level 1				
Sol-fa: Level 1	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 2				
Sol-fa: Level 2	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study Afternoon Listening	
Music: Level 3				
Sol-fa: Level 3 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 4				
Sol-fa: Level 4 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 5				
Sol-fa: Level 5 Afternoon Listening	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view

online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Folk Songs



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Our Work: Grade 3



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Our Work: Grades 7-8



Our Work: Grades 9-12



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Folk Songs

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do

you think the composer wrote it the way he did?

- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.

- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.

Folk Songs

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Term 1

WEEK 1

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 1

Yankee Doodle

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: Lyrics are included in your Our Work booklet or Music PDF. Print off the tune if you like as well.

∞ PDF Link: [Yankee Doodle Sheet Music](#)

→ INTRO

What does the word "Yankee" mean? Our first folk song of the year is one of the most famous American folk songs, but it actually started as a British insult! Learn more about the history and then listen to the song today.

∞ Article Link: [Yankee Doodle History](#)

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: [Yankee Doodle](#)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Feel free to choose your own version of Yankee Doodle to learn. Just know that the lyrics vary widely, so another audio or video is unlikely to match the words in your Our Work or Music books.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to the term's songs throughout the week!

• IMPORTANT DATE

Yankee Doodle was first composed (~1755 AD)

WEEK 2

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 2

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, United States Atlas or a Globe

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of "Yankee Doodle"?

→ SING

Listen to the full song, paying attention to the lyrics. Then listen again and hum along. You might want to march as well! Spend some time reading and memorizing the lyrics (use your Our Work or Music booklet).

∞ Video Link: [Yankee Doodle](#)

→ EXPLORE

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, explore pieces that have Yankee Doodle incorporated into them! Just as books make references to earlier works, composers often make musical references to other songs. The more you know about music, the more musical references you will catch! It's like picking up on an inside joke in a conversation!

∞ Article & Video: [200 Years of Yankee Doodle](#)

WEEK 3

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 3

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "Yankee Doodle"?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Write down the first line of each verse to help yourself remember the order. Then sing along with the recording. If you need to focus more closely on the words, pause the video after a line and echo it back yourself.

∞ Video Link: [Yankee Doodle](#)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL)

Like most folk songs (and even hymns), many different verses have come and gone from Yankee Doodle. If you want a challenge, try composing some of your own additional or alternate verses! Try singing your lyrics with the tune to make sure you have the right rhythm (you'll notice that there are four beats in each line).

• MUSIC CONNECTION

If you play an instrument, try playing the melody of Yankee Doodle!

WEEK 4

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 4

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of "Yankee Doodle" as you can from memory. Note the spots where you get stuck!

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics and work on any spots you got stuck. Then try singing the song with the instrumental (use your lyrics, not the video's). When it ends, keep singing the rest of the verses a cappella. Make up your own accompaniment by clapping or marching if you like!

∞ Video Link: [Yankee Doodle Tune](#)

→ DISCUSS

Can you imagine being a soldier and first hearing this tune as an insult? Can you think of any other examples of something that started as a put-down but was then reclaimed to mean something else?

• EXTRA HELPINGS (Grade 10+) Read Percival Everett's short story "The Appropriation of Cultures" (linked in Extra Helpings) to think more about how songs or other cultural symbols gain and change connotations.



Term 1

WEEK 5

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 5

Yankee Doodle (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of Yankee Doodle as you can from memory.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Work on any spots you struggled with in the recap. Then, using the instrumental track or just your voice, sing all of Yankee Doodle (use lyrics if needed). Experiment with how you sing each verse. Try singing one loud and proud, another like you're telling a secret to a friend, etc. If you wrote any of your own verses, add them in as well!

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle Tune

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL)

Refine or add more of your own verses to the song!

WEEK 6

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 6

Sakura, Sakura

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP

Hum or sing the first few verses of Yankee Doodle.

→ INTRO

Today we're starting a new folk song about cherry blossoms! The tune originated sometime during the Edo Period (1603-1868) in Japan, which was a time of relative stability and peace. Over the years, it has become internationally famous and has been performed around the world.

→ VIEW & MAPWORK

Cherry blossoms have been important to Japanese culture for centuries, and festivals to view them in peak season take place every spring. Learn a bit more about this tradition and look at the pictures of some of the beautiful places in Japan. You may want to pull out Google Maps or an atlas and locate the different places mentioned as well!

∞ Article Link: Sakura in Japan

→ LISTEN

Listen to the song once or twice and follow along with the lyrics. Print off the sheet music tune if desired.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

∞ Image Link: Sakura Sheet Music

WEEK 7

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 7

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum the beginning of the tune of Sakura, Sakura?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the song and pay attention to how each word is pronounced. Then listen again and pause the video after each line to echo it back.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

→ VIEW

The song is often performed on the koto, a Japanese stringed instrument which became very popular in the 1700s. Listen to this instrumental version of our song with extra time.

∞ Video Link: Sakura Sakura (Koto)

WEEK 8

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 8

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite as many of the words (or sing as much of the song) as you can from memory.

→ INTRO

Did you know that Japan gifted thousands of cherry trees to the US in the early 1900s? To this day, people flock to Washington, DC, to see the cherry blossoms in the spring!

∞ Article Link: Cherry Blossoms in the US

→ SING

Folk Songs

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Term 1

Continue working on the words and tune! Focus on the words by pausing the video after a line to echo the song back.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

WEEK 9

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 9

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Yankee Doodle" from earlier in the term. Can you remember it?

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen to the full song once, following along with the words. Then try to sing the song yourself a cappella (with just your voice).

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

→ STUDY

If you take sol-fa or an instrument, look at the sheet music of this folk song and count how many different tones are used. The same note in a different octave doesn't add to the count (for instance, just count one B). How many different tones did you find? [Answer: 5] Much of Japanese music is composed with a scale of five notes, and this song uses the hirajoshi scale (see examples in the link below). This scale is a default scale for the koto instrument as standardized by a famous Koto player in the 17th century, Yatsushashi Kengyō. Play around with these five notes and see what other tunes you can come up with, or try playing Sakura starting on a different note than shown in the sheet music, but using the same scale.

∞ Image Link: Sakura Sheet Music

∞ Article Link: Hirajoshi Scale

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Using the hirajoshi scale, compose an "introduction" or ending melody to Sakura, Sakura.

WEEK 10

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 10

Sakura, Sakura (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What would you say is the "mood" or feeling of Sakura based on what you know about the words?

→ SING

Can you sing the song from memory now? Listen to the song first before trying, if needed.

∞ Video Link: Sakura, Sakura

WEEK 11

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 11

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ DISCUSS

Which folk song from the term was your favorite? Why?

→ SING

Sing both songs from the term. Use the instrumental with the first part of Yankee Doodle if desired.

∞ Video Link: Yankee Doodle Tune

WEEK 12

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Folk Songs

Term 2

WEEK 1

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 13

Amazing Grace

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, and Our Hymns Our Heritage (optional)

PREP: Choose which version of Amazing Grace you want to learn. V1 skips verse 3 in your Music PDF, and V2 omits verse 5 and flips verses 3 and 4, so that the song ends with "The Lord has promised good." Annotate your page according to what you choose.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V1

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V2

→ INTRO

Folk songs and hymns are sometimes overlapping categories of music because some hymns become part of the wider culture to the point that they are also folk songs. Amazing Grace is one of those hymns - you probably already know at least some of the song! Read more about the history of this hymn from Our Hymns, Our Heritage, p.238, and/or the link below.

∞ Article Link: The Creation of Amazing Grace

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

The first verse of Amazing Grace is the most famous, and the other verses are sung in various orders. Read the words aloud for the verses you're learning, then listen to the recording (V1 or V2).

• IMPORTANT DATE

Amazing Grace was composed in (1772 AD)

WEEK 2

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 14

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or world atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the story of John Newton and Amazing Grace?

→ SING

Listen and hum through Amazing Grace (listen to a verse, then hum or "hoo" along with the next one) to learn the tune. Then practice reciting the words.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V1

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V2

→ DRAW

Sketch or paint a short illustration to go with each verse.

WEEK 3

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 15

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse from memory?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Write down the first line of each verse you're learning to help you remember the flow of the song. Then sing along with the recording. For lines/verses you don't know well yet, pause the video after the line and sing it back to help you focus on learning that line well.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V1

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace V2

→ LISTEN

As with all folk songs, the singer and musicians have a lot of freedom to put their own spin on the song. What do you think of this version? Notice which verses she sings or omits.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace (Usha Uthup)

WEEK 4

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 16

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of Amazing Grace as you can from memory.

→ SING

Check your work with your Our Work booklet or Music PDF and then try to sing with the accompaniment (don't refer to the lyrics on the video because - you guessed it - the lyrics are in a different order again!). Feel free to learn the extra verse to the song in your Our Work/Music book if you're feeling confident about the others!

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace Tune

→ LISTEN

Here is a country version of Amazing Grace. What do you like (or not) about this style?

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace (Alan Jackson)

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 5

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 17

Amazing Grace (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: Print off just the Amazing Grace page from your Our Work/Music Selection PDF and cut the paper so that each verse is on its own strip of paper.

→ RECAP

Can you recite the first line of each verse of "Amazing Grace" that you're learning?

→ SING

Read the words aloud and focus on any that you're still a little unsure of. Then sing along with the instrumental (use lyrics if needed or sing from memory).

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace Tune

→ REFLECT

You've heard people sing Amazing Grace in a variety of ways and put the verses in different arrangements. Look at the verses in your Our Work/Music Selection book (or use the pre-cut paper) and put the song together a few different ways (you can switch the order of verses or the number). Which way do you like best and why?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Look at Newton's original six verses and the famous last verse that was added later, and skim the list of recordings that have been made of the song!

∞ **Article Link:** Original Lyrics

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Listen to Aretha Franklin's Grammy-winning performance of Amazing Grace and Il Divo's very different performance in the afternoons this week.

∞ **Video Link:** Amazing Grace (Franklin)

∞ **Video Link:** Amazing Grace (Il Divo)

WEEK 6

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 18

En roulant ma boule

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, colored pencils, or markers

→ RECAP

Sing Amazing Grace from memory (or look at lyrics if needed). Think about the words and try to sing in a way that matches them!

→ INTRO

We're learning a new folk song today! In the 17th and 18th centuries, France claimed a significant portion of land in North America (see map link below). France's financial situation eventually collapsed, and they lost the Seven Years' War with England in 1763, but French voyageurs spent decades paddling through the Great Lakes and down the Mississippi and Missouri rivers (see Extra Helpings for more on the Voyageurs!) to transport furs. As they paddled, they sang to pass the time and keep their strokes even. Our folk song for the rest of this term was one of the songs the voyageurs sang.

∞ Map Link: New France in its Heyday

→ STUDY

The story of this song is odd and looks long, but you'll notice why it's a good paddling song when you listen to the tune and rhythm. But first, look at the lyrics in your Our Work/Music book. With your colored pencils or markers, mark, highlight, or underline the lines which are repeated (for instance, use the same color to highlight/mark the second and fourth line of each verse, which are ALWAYS the same).

→ LISTEN

If you can, follow along with the lyrics in your book as you listen. Pay attention especially to the refrain today and focus just on learning those words.

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule

∞ Image Link: En roulant sheet music (optional; helpful if you want to look at the tune)

WEEK 7

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 19

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

What does "En roulant ma boule" mean? Warm up your voice by singing Amazing Grace.

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen once to the song and follow along with the lyrics in your book. Then listen again and try humming along with some of the verses.

∞ Video Link: En roulant ma boule

• Did you notice that when the first lines of the verse repeat, the singer sings them louder the second time? Why do you think that is?

WEEK 8

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 20

En roulant ma boule

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Tell what you remember about the people who often sang "En roulant ma boule" in the 1600s and 1700s.

Term 2

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

As French voyageurs paddled, they often sang in a call-and-response format where the leader sang one line and the rest of the men responded. Try singing "En roulant ma boule" in this style by singing along on repeated sections. For instance, let the singer sing the first two lines of the refrain, then you join in when it's repeated. Similarly, listen to the first two lines of each verse and then try joining in when they are repeated. (The singer tries to naturally mimic this call-and-response style by singing louder on the repeated sections.)

∞ Video Link: [En roulant ma boule](#)

WEEK 9

📅 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 21

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing the refrain of "En roulant ma boule."

→ SING & PRACTICE

Pause the video after each line of the first verse (or first and second if you're up for a challenge) and sing it back by yourself, and finish by just listening to the rest of the song. Listen closely to the pronunciation!

∞ Video Link: [En roulant ma boule](#)

WEEK 10

📅 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 22

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse of "En roulant ma boule" from memory?

→ SING

Sing along with the video for the sections you know. Pause and echo back the lines of the next verse or two you are working on.

∞ Video Link: [En roulant ma boule](#)

→ DISCUSS

If you wrote a paddle song, what would it be about? What tune would you use? If you want a challenge, try writing your own paddle song (tune and/or words) this week!

WEEK 11

📅 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 23

En roulant ma boule (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Sing along with the video for the sections you know. Pause and echo back the lines of the next verse or two you are working on.

∞ Video Link: [En roulant ma boule](#)

WEEK 12

📅 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

The term's folk songs.

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 25

Shenandoah

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: Print sheet music if desired.
∞ Image Link: Shenandoah Sheet Music

→ INTRO

What do you remember about "En roulant ma boule" from last term? We're learning two more songs that might have been sung on the water this term! The first is called "Shenandoah."

→ READ & SING

Staying true to folk tradition, the lyrics for Shenandoah have multiple historical roots and are a bit cryptic. Read the words in your Our Work/Music book, then listen to the song and read the video caption.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

WEEK 2

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 26

Shenandoah (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, US atlas

→ MAPWORK & RECAP

Locate the Missouri River in your atlas or online. What is Shenandoah about?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics aloud, then listen to the song, listening to a verse and then humming the next.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

• How does this song feel different than "En roulant ma boule"? What type of boat or work do you think this song suits best?

WEEK 3

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 27

Shenandoah (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing (or hum) the tune of the Shenandoah?

→ SING

Sing along with the video today. It may be helpful to pause after each line to sing the song back to give equal attention to all the words.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

→ READ

Learn more about Chief John Skenandoah. (Teachers may share selections for younger students.)

∞ Article Link: 1912 Tribute to Shenandoah

WEEK 4

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 28

Shenandoah (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Who was Chief John Shenandoah?

→ SING

Can you sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics? Sing along with the video today for the rest of the song, pausing to repeat any lines you are still working on.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

→ LISTEN

With extra time, listen to this orchestral rendition of the song.

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah (orchestra)

• IMPORTANT DATE

Chief John Skenandoah (New York, 1706-1816 AD)

WEEK 5

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 29

Shenandoah (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Sing Shenandoah a cappella, and try to see how far you can make it without looking at the lyrics. Check your work with the full song and practice any spots you don't know as well. Think about how your tone creates the meaning and emotion in the song, and try singing the song a few different ways (faster, slower, louder, softer, etc).

∞ Video Link: Shenandoah

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Listen to a different version of Shenandoah!

∞ Video Link: Sissel's Shenandoah

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time or on your own time, if interested, sketch or paint an illustration to go with the song.

WEEK 6

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 30

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Materials: Like a Bird, Our Work or Music PDF, atlas

PREP: If this book is new to you, read p.5 with your students.

→ RECAP

Sing Shenandoah to warm up your voice and refresh your memory.

→ INTRO

Unlike our previous folk songs from the north and Midwest, "Michael Row the Boat Ashore" comes from the east. Read a little about the song from Like a Bird, p.13.

→ LISTEN

Read the lyrics in your Our Work or Music book and then listen to the full song.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ MAPWORK

Look up the Georgia Sea Islands in your atlas or online.

WEEK 7

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 31

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum a part of our new song? What is its name?

→ SING

Like all of our rowing songs, "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore" can also be sung in a call-and-response format. This week, sing along with the response sections the "Hallelujah" after each line.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ LISTEN

Hear a version of our song sung in a call-and-response format. Notice the alternate lyrics as well.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat (Call & Response)

WEEK 8

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 32

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum the whole tune of "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore?"

→ SING

Take the role of the "leader" today and sing the first part of each line (not the "Hallelujah").

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ STUDY

No one knows exactly when this song first started, but possibly as early as the 1700s, rowers would make up their own verses.

∞ Song Link: Additional Lyrics

- How do these verses add to your understanding of the song?
- Consider learning a few more verses OR making up a few of your own.

★ TEACHER NOTE

In a group context, teachers can divide the class and have one half sing each line while the others respond with the "Hallelujah."

WEEK 9

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 33

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you tell the first lines of each of the verses you've learned for "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore"?

→ SING

Listen to the video and then try singing the song completely by yourself.

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ DISCUSS

How is "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore" similar or different from "Shenandoah" or "En roulant ma boule"? Which is your favorite water song?

WEEK 10

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 34

Michael, Row the Boat Ashore (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Do you remember the words to "Shenandoah"?

→ SING

Sing "Michael, Row the Boat Ashore" from memory, then listen to the video to check your work. Remember, you can add extra verses you've learned or composed if you like!

∞ Video Link: Michael, Row the Boat Ashore

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time, sketch or paint an illustration to go with this song.

WEEK 11

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 35

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Make sure to stand when you sing and do a few warm-ups to get your voice ready. Sing both folk songs from the term (maybe even try singing one from earlier in the year too!).

→ DISCUSS

Look back at your Our Work/Music book and discuss your favorite folk songs from the year.

WEEK 12

10m Folk Songs - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Folk Songs

Folk Songs

Examination

- Term 1** · Sing "Yankee Doodle" (add in your own verses if you came up with some!) OR "Sakura, Sakura" and tell a little about the song.
- Term 2** · Sing "Amazing Grace" and the refrain (or more if you want) of "En roulant ma boule."
- Term 3** · Sing "Shenandoah" and tell what you remember about Chief John Skenandoah.